

Caryse Chang

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EXPERIENCE

John Muir Health — *Student Supervisor (11, 12)*

November 2025 - Present

- Co-lead 12-person shift in a high-volume clinic, delegate tasks, ensure volunteers comply with hospital policies, and ensure department coordination
- Serve as the primary liaison between clinical staff and volunteer team, making sure volunteer services are directed to the highest-priority units while advocating for volunteer needs
- Organize team-bonding activities to build a better shift culture, helping volunteers feel more connected and motivated to stay with the program

Note by Note, Campolindo High School — *Founder, President (11, 12)*

August 2024 - Present

- Founded a community non-profit organization that provides affordable music instruction by pairing high school musicians with elementary and middle school students
- Through outreach, grew the organization to 117 students in Walamorinda
- Recruited and trained 50 high school mentors, pair mentors and students, and manage club funds
- Adjusted our program based on feedback from parents and mentors to make sure lessons stayed high-quality and the program worked for everyone

miRcore — *Member (11, 12), Group Leader (12)*

August 2024 - May 2025

- Alzheimer's Research: Led a computational biology research team in studying the genetic causes of Alzheimer's Disease, resulting in publication in the miRcore Science Journal
 - Explained confusing concepts or computational biology tool usage to team members, translating complex genomic and bioinformatic information into actionable steps teammates understood
- Advocacy: helped raise \$10,700 for frontotemporal dementia research, run middle school biology workshops that attracted approximately 500 middle school students, and design pamphlets to encourage vaccinations and science literacy
- Group leader: over senior year summer, mentored a cohort of 6 freshmen in miRcore's Computational Biology summer camp, guiding students through original research on Parkinson's disease and the camp's curriculum

Orchestra, Campolindo High School — *Section Leader (11, 12)*

August 2024 - Present

- Lead cello section of 11 members, teaching weekly sectionals to improve accuracy, intonation, & cohesion
 - Alternate between teaching the entire group and targeted one-on-one coaching to address differences in experience levels
- Advocate as student liaison, representing the section's logistical and musical concerns to the director
- Foster inclusive section culture by organizing and planning social events
- Senior year, was selected as cello section leader of the district orchestra, leading 23 cellists during the district music program's trip to Southern California

- Earned 'Unanimous Superior' (the highest possible rating) four years in a row at CMEA (California Music Educators' Association). As section leader, I was responsible for leading sectionals and ensuring group cohesion to ensure our section's intonation and rhythm met the judges' highest standards

JV Girls Tennis Team, Campolindo High School — Captain (11)

August 2024 - October 2024

- Led team of 16 players; acted as a bridge between different social groups on the team to resolve cliques; focused on building a unified culture through team lunches and bonding events
- Facilitated warmups, organized social events, communication between parents, coaches, and players, organized carpools, coached teammates, and led cheers
- Helped lead the team to 1st place at the James Logan Tournament by keeping energy high and coaching teammates through difficult matches

BioEHSC, UC Berkeley — Research Team Captain (11)

February 2025 - April 2025

- Directed 5-student research team in BioEHSC, an intensive 7-week bioengineering competition at UC Berkeley, overseeing project from problem identification to symposium presentation of our solution
- Set guidelines for each week's research goals and ensured everyone stayed up to date on our research process
- Mentored teammates in academic literature review and data synthesis

Symphony of Service — Chamber Group (9, 10, 11, 12)

June 2023 - present

- Over the summer, I organized & performed music with a chamber group of 4 other string players
- Over the past 4 years, we've played for 4 senior homes of about 35 seniors each & 2 middle schools
- Focused on choosing music our audience will enjoy, bringing joy to lonely seniors & engaging the local community through music

SKILLS

Team Building, Adaptable Communication, Conflict Mediation, Cross-Team Collaboration

AWARDS

Gold Presidential Volunteer Service Award (11)

- Earned the highest level of presidential national service award for 250+ hours of community service from service in senior homes, the hospital, miRcore advocacy, middle school biology workshops, etc.

Type 1 Diabetes publication – Nexus Research Journal (11, 12)

- Independently authored a research paper analyzing the genetic cause of Type 1 Diabetes using computational bioinformatics; published in Nexus Journal, an international high school research journal, as 1 of 2 papers
- Findings: due to the upregulation of several genes in the IL-17 signaling pathway (which controls immune response), the pancreas becomes inflamed, killing beta cells that are responsible for producing insulin.